Unicity Wallet · UX research

What we need to learn before we build

Unicity is building a wallet that lets people send money like texting a friend. Before we design anything, we need to understand how people actually manage money today — and what would make them trust a new app with it.

Method: Contextual Inquiry + Semi-structured interviews · Participants: 5 · Duration: ~45 min each · Format: Remote (Google Meet)

01 · GOALS

Research goals

1. Understand how people do Transfer, pay, send and receive money day to day, and what frustrates them
2. Find what makes people trust, or stop trusting, a wallet with their money
3. Check if the core idea there is the concept can be checked quickly and without explanation
4. Confirm or reshape the three point usecases of the next based.

02 · QUESTIONS

Research questions

1. What motivates a person to open their phone, and in what setting (queue, market, home)?
2. What do people check before they press Pay or Send?
3. How do people picture payments to a seller or friend in Europe?
4. What do people expect to see about fees and what time?
5. How do people learn something, if at all?
6. What happens when something goes wrong—long recovery, forgotten PIN, no signal?

03 · HYPOTHESES

What we believe, and how we will test it

H1 · Due to the scarcity of the app the volume of the payment flows	Partially
H2 · Showing recipient name and amount (3 taps) before Send reduces wrong-transfers.	Partially
H3 · Showing the exact amount before confirming raises trust in the app.	Partially
H4 · A change to and privacy and experience (Privacy, Security) is important.	Partially

Success rules: the recommendation, adjust it, or forget.

04 · METHOD

Research plan

session	name	work detail	what we can
P1	Anastasiia Ivanova	Freelance designer, Kyiv	4-6 sessions	Business goals, legal limits, top support issues	Planned
P2	Mykola Petrenko	Small-business owner, Lviv	4-5 people	Habits, trust triggers, pain points, quotes	Planned
P3	Olena Kovalchuk	Retired teacher, Odesa	4-5 days	Failure to notice, gaps in info, feasible solution	Planned
P4	Dmytro Shevchenko	Software engineer, Kharkiv	2 months 1 place 5	Task success, time, errors, SUS, issues to fix	Test
P5	Nataliia Bondar	Nurse, Dnipro	Charge/ Layered	Feature priority, the sensitivity, satisfaction baseline	Planned

05 · USER STORY

Tasks and success criteria

Task	Scenario	Audience	Success criteria
T1	You just downloaded the app. Create an account and set a PIN.	P1 · P2 · P3 · P4 · P5	Loads on Home without help
T2	Send 500 to your friend Ivan for dinner.	P1 · P2 · P3 · P4 · P5	Correct person and amount, can share the slip
T3	Pay the coffee shop by scanning its QR code.	P1 · P2 · P3	Pays the right amount, confirms the shop name
T4	Add 5000 to your wallet from your bank.	P1 · P2	Can say the fee and arrival time
T5	Pay this month's electricity bill.	P1 · P2	Bill paid, can find the receipt again
T6	How much did you spend last month?	P1 · P2	Shows a total without counting by hand

06 · USABILITY TEST

Tasks and success criteria

Measure: the same task, consistently. One or two errors, max 30 s.

Task	Scenario	Audience	Success criteria
T1	You just downloaded the app. Create an account and set a PIN.	P1 · P2 · P3 · P4 · P5	Loads on Home without help
T2	Send 500 to your friend Ivan for dinner.	P1 · P2 · P3 · P4 · P5	Correct person and amount, can share the slip
T3	Pay the coffee shop by scanning its QR code.	P1 · P2 · P3	Pays the right amount, confirms the shop name
T4	Add 5000 to your wallet from your bank.	P1 · P2	Can say the fee and arrival time
T5	Pay this month's electricity bill.	P1 · P2	Bill paid, can find the receipt again
T6	How much did you spend last month?	P1 · P2	Shows a total without counting by hand

07 · INTERVIEW GUIDE

From a heuristic review of this concept

1. **Fees are placeholders.** 0% / 0.5% and 12 times (free), 1 per minute and working are marked before testing 5%.
2. **No error or offline states.** Failed payment, wrong PIN, timeout and no signal screens are not designed yet.
3. **Forgot PIN is inactive.** Will time, 5 s, but the recovery flow and identity check are missing.
4. **Accessibility not checked.** Contrast, text scaling, VoiceOver and TalkBack labels, and Ukrainian support.

Unicity Wallet · Personas

Three people we are designing for

Based on the research findings and assumptions. Validate and revise these after interviews in the research plan.

Persona · Illustrative · Three personas · Jun validated

P Pinchanok, 28 · Bangkok, Thailand · Freelance graphic designer

Primary · The main audience

"I just want to scan, pay, and get on with my day. And at the end of the month I need to know where it all went."

Habits
- Pays coffee, lunch, and transport by QR or tap-to-pay
- Splits bills with friends often
- Sees monthly spending without a spreadsheet

Pain Points
- Crowded home screens full of promotions
- Forgets to check a bill until it is overdue
- Hunting for old apps in the App Store

Behaviors
- Scans QR to pay
- Uses Apple Pay
- Tap-to-pay

Channels
- Instagram
- Facebook
- Messenger
- Email

Jobs to be done
- Pay for things quickly and safely
- Split bills with friends
- Keep track of spending

Needs and expectations
- Fast, minimal steps
- Clear, simple interface
- Trustworthy and secure

Frustrations
- Too many steps to pay
- Unclear fees
- Slow loading

S Somchai, 52 · Mobile shop owner · Chiang Mai · Secondary · Pre-validation

Secondary · Pre-validation

"When a customer says they paid, I need to see it straight away. I can't stop the queue to check."

Habits
- Sell about 50 and more the money on hand
- Keeps a notebook by the till as a backup
- Keep a simple record for his family and taxes

Pain Points
- Small text and too many steps
- Worried about fees and hidden charges
- Worried about protecting his shop and money

Behaviors
- Shows the QR to buyer
- Whatsapp to his wife
- Large and calling
- Likes family for free

Channels
- Line
- Facebook
- Whatsapp
- Email

Jobs to be done
- Get paid by QR and know the money arrived
- Keep a record for his family and his shop
- Keep a simple record for his family and taxes

Needs and expectations
- Clear, simple interface
- Trustworthy and secure

Frustrations
- Too many steps to pay
- Unclear fees
- Slow loading

N Nicha, 20 · Mae Sot, Thailand · Cross-border trader · Work Visa

Secondary · Pre-validation

"Every month, I send a lot. And it is slow, but not before I top, not after."

Habits
- Top up her phone and pay small amounts
- Must be money from parents and saved it to month end
- Sends money to family in Myanmar

Pain Points
- Fees, slow and unreliable
- Limited to her phone and has ID
- Low balance found only at the checkout
- Can't get a receipt after sending the money documents

Behaviors
- Sends money to family in Myanmar
- Top up her phone
- Checks balance often
- Compares apps

Channels
- Facebook
- Line
- Whatsapp
- Email

Jobs to be done
- Send money to family in Myanmar
- Top up her phone and pay small amounts
- Must be money from parents and saved it to month end
- Sends money to family in Myanmar

Needs and expectations
- Fees, slow and unreliable
- Limited to her phone and has ID
- Low balance found only at the checkout
- Can't get a receipt after sending the money documents

Frustrations
- Fees, slow and unreliable
- Limited to her phone and has ID
- Low balance found only at the checkout
- Can't get a receipt after sending the money documents

Unicity Wallet · Research Synthesis

From first open to everyday money habit

Seven stages, mapped to the scenes in this canvas. Personas and emotions are working assumptions to validate with user research.

Pinchanok, 28 · Office worker, Bangkok · Tests groceries, bills, and sending money to her family every month · Comfortable with her phone, not with finance

Frustrations · crowded home apps, unclear fees, fear of sending money to the wrong person

Discover	Sign up and onboard	Top up	Pay and transfer	Confirm	Receive and track	Watch and manage
Sees a friend's money app and asks if she can try it.	Has set up quickly and safely.	Finds easy only the easiest.	Pays a shop or sends money to a friend.	Wants to know the fee and how long it will take.	Expects to see the money arrive.	Trusts spending and keep bills pass.
Hears about the app from a friend or sees it in a community review.	Enjoys phone number, verifies OTP, sets a 6-digit PIN, reads an income.	Tops Top up, picks a bank account, enters how much to add.	Scans a shop QR or picks a saved contact, enters the amount, taps Pay or Send.	Enters the PIN or uses Face ID.	Sees the success screen, shares the slip or a link, goes back to Home.	Checks history, pays a bill from a reminder, manages linked accounts.
Actions: Downloads app · Opens app	Actions: Enters phone · Verifies OTP · Sets PIN	Actions: Taps Top up · Enters amount · Confirms	Actions: Scans QR · Confirms amount · Taps Send	Actions: Enters PIN · Confirms fee	Actions: Sees success · Shares receipt	Actions: Checks history · Pays bill · Manages cards
"Is this just another wallet full of scams?"	"How long will this take?"	"Is there a fee? What does it cost me?"	"Am I sending this to the right person?"	"Is my money safe?"	"Did it work? Where did my money go?"	"When did my money go into mine?"
Pain: Too many apps to choose from · Unclear what makes this one different.	Pain: Long forms · Unsure what documents are needed · Worried about sharing personal data.	Pain: Unsure what fees will be charged · Worried about hidden costs · Doesn't know how long it will take.	Pain: Fear of sending money to the wrong person · Typing a name is easy to get wrong.	Pain: Fees are not shown upfront · Exchange rate is unclear · Doesn't know how long it will take.	Pain: Doesn't know if the payment went through · Can't find a receipt.	Pain: Can't find past transactions · Can't export for taxes or records.
Opportunities: Clear, simple promise above the fold · Let Pina answer questions · Build trust with social proof.	Opportunities: Show sign-up progress and why each step is needed · Autofill where possible.	Opportunities: Show the exact amount and fees before confirming · Offer the smallest top-up first.	Opportunities: Show the exact amount and fees before confirming · Offer a clear "Sending to [name]" screen.	Opportunities: Show fees upfront · Show the exact amount and fees before confirming · Offer a clear "Sending to [name]" screen.	Opportunities: Show a clear success screen · Offer to share a receipt · Show the new balance.	Opportunities: Group transactions by day · Make them searchable · Offer to export for taxes.

Pain Points
- Too many apps to choose from · Unclear what makes this one different.
- Long forms · Unsure what documents are needed · Worried about sharing personal data.
- Unsure what fees will be charged · Worried about hidden costs · Doesn't know how long it will take.
- Fear of sending money to the wrong person · Typing a name is easy to get wrong.
- Fees are not shown upfront · Exchange rate is unclear · Doesn't know how long it will take.
- Doesn't know if the payment went through · Can't find a receipt.
- Can't find past transactions · Can't export for taxes or records.

Opportunities
- Clear, simple promise above the fold · Let Pina answer questions · Build trust with social proof.
- Show sign-up progress and why each step is needed · Autofill where possible.
- Show the exact amount and fees before confirming · Offer the smallest top-up first.
- Show the exact amount and fees before confirming · Offer a clear "Sending to [name]" screen.
- Show fees upfront · Show the exact amount and fees before confirming · Offer a clear "Sending to [name]" screen.
- Show a clear success screen · Offer to share a receipt · Show the new balance.
- Group transactions by day · Make them searchable · Offer to export for taxes.

Emotional arc

Curious → Hesitant → Confident → Trusting → Habitual

Key insights

Trust is the main barrier, not features. Fees and speed are the two things people ask about first. Errors and recovery matter more than the happy path.

Next steps

Test the "Discover" and "Sign up and onboard" stages with 5 users. Validate the fee and speed assumptions. Design the "Confirm" and "Pay and transfer" screens.

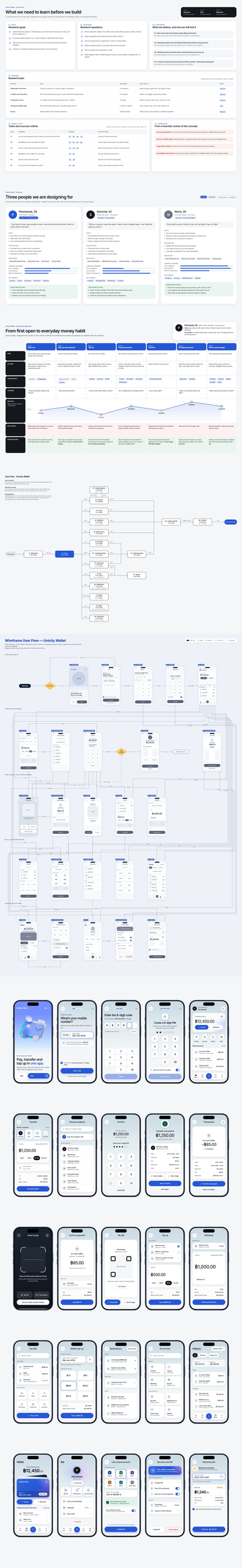
User flow · Unicity Wallet

How to read this

Each row is one task. Boxes are screens or states. Arrows show what the user can do next. Dashed boxes are optional or error paths.

Key terms in this flow

- **Unicity ID** — the user's name on the network (for example, `@alice`). Set when the wallet is created.
- **Nametag** — a unique name that points to a Unicity ID. Used to receive payments.
- **Token** — a piece of digital money. Each token has a value and a type (for example, USDC or ETH).
- **Split** — breaking a token into smaller tokens so you can send an exact amount.
- **Intent** — a signed message that says "I want to send this token to that nametag."
- **Proof** — a cryptographic receipt that the network accepted the transfer.
- **Aggregator** — the service that collects transfers and records them on the network.
- **Inclusion proof** — proof that a transfer is recorded on the network.
- **Finalized** — the transfer is complete and cannot be reversed.
- **Pending** — sent, but not yet recorded on the network.
- **Failed** — the network rejected the transfer.



Wireframe User Flow — Unicity Wallet

Mobile wallet flow, iOS and Android. Covers onboarding, send, receive, and settings. Designed around the Unicity Wallet SDK (TypeScript / Swift / Kotlin).